conquer the entire neighbourhood, which included modern day Ladakh, Balur (around Gilgit), Badakhshan and other fragments of Moghūlistan.[‡]

In AD 1514, Sulṭān Said Khān took Kashgar from him. With age, his control had weakened. He feared losing Yarkand and Khotan next, and hence passed on the government to his eldest son Jahangir Mīrzā. Following the handing over of government, he attempted to flee to Ladakh, but failed.[§] He was just twenty miles north of Xaidulla when he was intercepted and killed by pursuers sent by Sulṭān Said Khān.

Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that Abu Bakr was the one who never bowed to anyone in his lifetime and now after the demise of Umar Shaikh Mīrzā, his eyes were all set on Ferghana. With Abu Bakr's desire to capture Babur's rightful land, he came closer and built a fort in the vicinity of Auzkint. He had gradually begun to lay waste to the land. Looking at the ravishing done by him, several begs led by the great Khwaja Qazi were sent to drive him out. The begs proved their worth, and the land was freed from him.

Babur seems to have been very thankful for his begs, whom he has deeply praised in his memoir.

A few days had passed since Babur's father's demise. Several counter-attacks had to be organized to keep the land safe in Babur's hands.

Meantime, Babur's grandmother, Shah Sulṭān Begum, Jahangir Mīrzā and the whole harem along with the Akhsi begs had come to Andijān. As they arrived, the customary mourning was fulfilled, and food and victuals were given to the poor.

As the circumstances threatened to get direr, the focus was laid completely on setting administration rights and organizing the army order.

Following were the major changes made:

1. Hasan was given the responsibility of guarding Babur's Gate and administer the Andijān government.
2. The responsibility of Osh was given to Qasim Quichin.
3. Akhsi and Margilal's responsibility went into the hands of Auzn Hasan and A Dost Taghai.
4. The rest of loyal Umar's begs and brave warlords were each assigned distric land, designation in court, or some stipends were committed.

On the other hand, after being kicked out, Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā contracted high fever on his route back home. His health began to deteriorate badly. He died in July AD 1494 at the age of forty-four just as he reached Aksu.